Competency-Based Technical and Vocational Teaching

LET · technical-vocational-teacher-education · BoardPrep lesson v2

Official examination scope

Original review of competency-based outcomes, demonstration assessment, workshop safety, feedback, and industry-informed learning. Scope is limited to the linked official board outline and curriculum references; this is not an exam prediction.

Learning objectives

- Translate a workplace competency standard into observable learning outcomes and assessment
- conditions.
- Demonstrate, scaffold, and assess technical performance using transparent criteria and
- sufficient evidence.
- Select training materials, equipment, and safety controls that match the task and learners.
- Use feedback, remediation, workplace coordination, and enterprise contexts to support
- competence and employability.

1. Competency and performance evidence

A competency integrates the knowledge, skill, attitudes, and judgment needed to perform work to an expected standard. Start with the applicable competency standard or training regulation; identify the task, performance criteria, conditions, tools, and evidence guide. A learner demonstrates competence through performance evidence, not time spent in training alone. Do not replace a workplace outcome with a teacher’s preference for one method if multiple safe, valid methods can meet the standard.

- Convert each unit into observable actions and a product or service standard.
- Include operating conditions and safety practices where they are part of the competency.
- Distinguish an essential criterion from an optional stylistic preference.

2. Demonstrate, practice, and coach

A useful technical demonstration makes process and decision points visible. State the task and hazard controls, model a whole performance or meaningful segment, narrate critical checks, and invite learners to identify why each check matters. Then move to guided practice with feedback, followed by a new performance opportunity. Fade prompts as performance stabilizes. A video or diagram can supplement demonstration, but learners still need an accessible opportunity to perform and receive feedback.

- Model the sequence at a pace learners can observe.
- Ask a learner to identify a quality or safety checkpoint before practice.
- Move from supported rehearsal toward performance under the competency conditions.

3. Safety is part of competence

Safety is an observable part of technical performance whenever the work standard includes it. Before practice, inspect the tool, work area, materials, personal protective equipment, and controls relevant to the task. Stop work if a condition becomes unsafe; correct or isolate the hazard according to the institution’s procedures before resuming. Do not reward a fast output that was produced through an unsafe method. Exact legal procedures, equipment limits, and PPE requirements depend on the current trade-specific standards and local rules.

- Brief learners on the actual task hazards and controls before work begins.
- Correct unsafe conditions rather than relying on a warning alone.
- Use current trade-specific standards for regulatory details.

4. Assessment, remediation, and workplace links

Assessment should gather sufficient, relevant evidence and compare it with the criteria before making a judgment. A practical assessment may combine direct observation, product inspection, questioning about decisions, and records of performance under specified conditions. Feedback should name the criterion, the observed evidence, and a next practice step. If evidence is incomplete, provide additional opportunity; do not infer competence from attendance or confidence. Workplace learning needs agreed supervision, safe tasks, and clear links between practice and expected competencies.

- Choose evidence that directly demonstrates the competency.
- Explain the gap and next practice opportunity in criterion language.
- Coordinate workplace roles, observation, and evidence with the training plan.

5. From competency standard to learning outcome

TESDA describes competency-based curricula as specifying outcomes, content, learning conditions, methods, and assessment aligned with workplace requirements. Read the performance criteria and evidence guide before designing a lesson. Turn a criterion into a learner-facing outcome that states an observable action and condition. Then sequence the prerequisite knowledge and practice learners need. If a regulation or industry requirement changes, verify the current controlling text before teaching it as mandatory.

- Use action verbs tied to visible performance, such as measure, assemble, test, or explain.
- Preserve the standard’s conditions and performance criteria in the outcome and assessment.
- Consult current trade or industry evidence when a requirement is time-sensitive.

6. Demonstration, practice, and transfer

Technical learning requires deliberate, repeated practice that bridges a model and authentic performance. Break a complex procedure into teachable steps without hiding how the steps work together. Model the task, let learners rehearse under support, then vary materials or conditions so they can transfer the skill. Ask learners to explain decisions and perform critical checks. Keep workspaces and learner groups safe, and ensure each trainee gets direct practice rather than only watching a partner.

- Use a brief demonstration, then rotate learners through actual practice.
- Give feedback on one high-value process feature at a time.
- Vary the scenario only after foundational performance is sufficiently stable.

7. Performance evidence and assessment

A competency decision should be based on sufficient evidence directly related to the standard. Observe the learner perform, inspect the product or service, and ask focused questions when they clarify a decision that was not visible. Use clear criteria in a practical rubric: required process, output quality, safety checks, and task conditions. A rubric describes observable levels; it does not disguise personal preference as a standard. If assessors disagree, compare the evidence and the standard rather than relying on seniority.

- Map each criterion to a visible action or product feature.
- State the conditions and resources available during assessment.
- Record evidence before deciding that a learner is competent or needs more practice.

8. Learning materials and training environment

TESDA’s glossary describes competency-based learning materials that can include a learner guide, competency list, learning outcomes, information sheets, self-checks, task or operation sheets, job sheets, and performance checklists. Choose only the materials that support the target outcome and sequence them so learners can prepare, practice, check understanding, and demonstrate performance. Maintain equipment and work areas according to applicable procedures; replace a damaged tool rather than asking learners to work around a hazard.

- Use a self-check for retrieval or readiness, not as a substitute for performance evidence.

- Make task sheets precise enough to support safe practice while preserving learner
- problem-solving.
- Keep criteria and required resources visible to learners.

9. Safety and workplace learning

Workplace learning connects training with authentic practice, but authenticity never excuses uncontrolled hazards or unclear responsibilities. Coordinate the assigned task, supervision, available equipment, safety orientation, and evidence to be collected. The PRC BTVTEd common competencies include occupational health, safety, and ethical values. TESDA circulars and trade standards may change, so verify current requirements for a specific qualification instead of using an old remembered rule. An unsafe task should be stopped and referred through the training site's procedures.

- Confirm that the placement task matches the learner's training and supervision.
- Agree which person supervises, gives feedback, and records evidence.
- Escalate an unsafe or out-of-scope assignment before the learner begins.

10. Industry links, feedback, and employability

Industry input helps keep learning outcomes connected to work, but the curriculum must still remain coherent and teachable. Ask employers or practitioners which performance standards and changing practices matter, then verify them against the current training regulation or documented industry evidence. Feedback should identify a criterion, observed performance, and a useful next step. Enterprise activities can connect technical quality to customer need, cost, reliability, and ethical practice; do not reduce entrepreneurship to selling without understanding the service or product.

- Use employer feedback as evidence to review outcomes, not as an unverified new rule.
- Discuss how quality and safety affect customer trust and employability.
- Use reassessment to verify improved performance rather than attendance at remediation.

Worked example: assessing a plumbing joint

Question: A trainee's joint holds water during a brief test, but the trainer did not observe preparation or safety steps. Is that enough evidence for the full competency?
1. Compare the task with the current unit standard and required conditions.
2. Identify which process and safety criteria were not observed.
3. Arrange a fair additional performance opportunity for the missing evidence.
Answer: The visible outcome may be relevant but is insufficient if required process and safety criteria remain unobserved.
Check: Does the evidence cover every mandatory performance criterion?

Worked example: matching a learning sheet to a task

Question: Learners are preparing to interpret a technical drawing before a supervised shop task. Which materials help them prepare and self-check?
1. State the drawing-reading outcome and the symbols/measurements to interpret.
2. Provide a concise information sheet and worked example.
3. Use a short self-check before the learners apply the skill to the task sheet.
Answer: Sequence information and self-checks to prepare learners, then gather direct evidence during authentic performance.
Check: Does the self-check prepare rather than replace the required performance assessment?

Common misconceptions

- Competence is demonstrated ability under stated conditions, not attendance or time in
- training.
- A practical rubric should represent observable criteria from the standard, not personal taste.

- Watching a demonstration does not substitute for every learner’s practice and performance
- evidence.
- Use current trade-specific requirements for regulations and exact PPE or equipment details.

Practice patterns

- Translate a standard into outcome, practice, and evidence.
- Choose what evidence is missing before making a competency decision.
- Respond to safety or quality gaps with a controlled next action.

Official scope references

Official scope: PRC Board Resolution No. 20, s. 2025, Annex A: LEPT alignment and specialization syllabi — Professional Regulatory Board for Professional Teachers / Professional Regulation Commission — https://www.prc.gov.ph/sites/default/files/2025-20%20Annex%20teachers.pdf

Instructional references

Instructional reference: TESDA Promulgated Training Regulations Index — Technical Education and Skills Development Authority, Philippines — https://tesda.gov.ph/Download/Training_Regulations?page=2
Instructional reference: 2025 TVET Glossary — Technical Education and Skills Development Authority, Philippines — https://www.tesda.gov.ph/Uploads/File/Glossary/2025%20TVET%20Glossary.pdf

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